

TR 2.8 Chapter 2 Test— Answer Key

Matching [Each correct answer is worth 1 point.]

Match each item to the correct answer.

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|---------------------------|---|
| <u>H</u> 1. Acts | A. Jewish literature written during the intertestamental period and included in the Bible by some branches of Christianity |
| <u>A</u> 2. Apocrypha | B. Biographies that tell the story of Jesus' life, death, and resurrection |
| <u>J</u> 3. Canon | C. Also known as <i>the Torah</i> ; composed of the first five books of the Old Testament |
| <u>D</u> 4. The Epistles | D. Letters that were written to help Christians live out their new lives in Jesus |
| <u>B</u> 5. The Gospels | E. Also called <i>Nevi'im</i> ; including Joshua, Judges, 1 and 2 Samuel, 1 and 2 Kings, and fifteen other books in the Bible |
| <u>I</u> 6. Inspiration | F. A book that inspires churches facing persecution and reveals God's plan to restore all things |
| <u>C</u> 7. The Law | G. Also known as <i>Ketuvim</i> ; includes the Psalms, Job, Proverbs, and everything else in the Tanakh |
| <u>E</u> 8. The Prophets | H. A New Testament book that describes the formation of the church |
| <u>F</u> 9. Revelation | I. The doctrine that God enabled people to write the words of Scripture |
| <u>G</u> 10. The Writings | J. The collection of biblical writings commonly accepted as genuine and authoritative |

Multiple Choice [Each correct answer is worth 1 point.]

Circle the correct answer(s) from the choices below. Some will have more than one answer.

11. What is the Bible?
 - a. **an ancient book**
 - b. **a book containing stories, poems, history, and prophecy**
 - c. **a collection of 66 books written by 40 authors during a span of at least 1,500 years**
 - d. a rule book that tells us how to behave
 - e. **a book that tells what God has done, is doing, and will do**
12. Which answer includes all the sections of most Protestant Bibles?
 - a. the Torah, *Nevi'im*, *Ketuvim*, and Tanakh
 - b. the Old Testament, the Apocrypha, the New Testament
 - c. the Gospels, Acts, the Epistles, and Revelation
 - d. the Law, the Prophets, and the New Testament
 - e. **the Old Testament and the New Testament**

13. What part(s) of God's story does the Old Testament tell?
- a. **the story of creation**
 - b. the history of the church
 - c. **the fall of humanity**
 - d. the story of the woman caught in adultery
 - e. **the history of Israel**
14. What part(s) of God's story does the New Testament tell?
- a. the story of Abraham
 - b. the exodus from Egypt
 - c. **the life, death, and resurrection of Jesus**
 - d. **the story of how the church was formed**
 - e. **the story of God's plan to restore all things**
15. What is true about the inspiration of the Bible?
- a. **It includes an active role for both God and humans.**
 - b. The inspiration of the Bible is entirely due to human ingenuity.
 - c. God dictated every word of Scripture aloud.
 - d. The inspiration of the Bible is just like the inspiration of a poem about nature.
 - e. **God preserved the personality and style of each author.**
16. How might someone evaluate the Bible's claims to be true?
- a. **by determining whether any evidence exists to support its historical claims**
 - b. **by asking whether it rings true to human experience**
 - c. **by getting to know its divine Author**
 - d. by accepting it is true because it says it is true
 - e. **by investigating whether it has contradictions and errors**
17. In speaking of ancient cultures, what is a myth?
- a. **It is a story that influences a culture's understanding and approach to the world.**
 - b. It is a popular belief that has been proven to be false.
 - c. It is what the authors of the Bible copied.
 - d. **It is just a made-up story.**
 - e. It is what the authors of the Bible critiqued.
18. What must we recall in assessing Bible passages that are at odds with modern science?
- a. Everything the Bible says should be taken literally.
 - b. Bible descriptions that do not agree with science today are just errors.
 - c. **The Bible explains things in ways that ancient Israelites could understand.**
 - d. **The Bible uses similes, metaphors, and other literary devices.**
 - e. **The Bible is God's revelation and not a science textbook.**

19. Mark the example(s) of external evidence.
- a. **archaeological discoveries confirming the existence of people and places in the Bible**
 - b. **non-Christian writings that refer to events in Scripture**
 - c. eyewitness testimony
 - d. the miracles recorded in the Bible
 - e. myths of the ancient Near East
20. Why do the Gospels appear to have contradictions in reporting details of Jesus' life?
- a. **because they are based on eyewitness testimony, and different eyewitnesses remember or emphasize different things**
 - b. because the gospel writers had faulty memories and made things up
 - c. **because they are similar to Greco-Roman biographies where authors frequently expanded, summarized, or reshuffled events to make theological or moral points**
 - d. because the church chose the wrong Gospels to be in the canon of Scripture
 - e. **because God wanted us to have different perspectives on the details of Jesus' life**
21. Why were the lost gospels excluded from the canon?
- a. because they were lost
 - b. **because they were not written by an apostle or anyone associated with an apostle**
 - c. **because they were not widely used by churches at that time**
 - d. **because they present a gnostic view of Jesus, one that was not taught by the apostles**
 - e. because of a mistake; they should have been included

True or False [Each question is worth 1 point.]

Indicate if each statement is true or false. If the statement is false, change the underlined word to make it true.

F 22. The original autographs are the original Hebrew, Latin, and Greek manuscripts of Scripture.
_____ **Aramaic** _____

T 23. A presupposition is a belief you assume is true. _____

F 24. To read Scripture well, we must be prepared to evaluate our inaccuracies in light of Scripture.
_____ **presuppositions** _____

F 25. In engaging biblical authors in a dialogue, we enter their world and judge them
by contemporary standards. _____ **do not judge** _____

F 26. The Bible was written for us but not to us, so we must understand what a passage meant to
its original orthodoxy before knowing what it means for us. _____ **audience** _____

Fill-in-the-blank [Each answer is worth 2 points. Questions 27 and 31 are worth 4 points.]

Fill in the missing word to complete each statement.

27. The context is the historical background and literary setting of a text that helps clarify its meaning.
28. The whole of Scripture either points ahead to Jesus as its fulfillment or looks back to him as the Author and Perfecter of our faith.
29. Scripture is “living and active, sharper than any two-edged sword” (Hebrews 4:12).
30. Scripture teaches that prophets “spoke from God as they were carried along by the Holy Spirit” (2 Peter 1:20–21).
31. Numbers 23:19 affirms that God does not lie and Proverbs 30:5 says that “every word of God proves true.”
32. In John 17:17, Jesus declared that God’s word is truth.

Short Answer [Each question is worth 3 points.]

Answer the following questions using complete sentences.

33. Why is inviting someone to read the Bible for themselves sometimes the best apologetic or argument for the Bible?
Inviting someone to read the Bible for themselves is sometimes the best apologetic for the Bible because God’s Word is powerful and it can do an amazing work within us. It is only by reading it that we can enter into its great story and experience its divine inspiration.
34. Use the story of Abraham or the story of the woman caught in adultery to describe what God’s character is like.
Answers will vary depending on the example chosen. In the story of Abraham, God revealed himself to Abraham on several occasions and proved himself to be worthy of trust. When God later asked Abraham to sacrifice Isaac, Abraham could trust God based on his past experiences with him. In the story of the woman caught in adultery, Jesus reveals God cares for and forgives sinners, does not want us to sin, and hates hypocrisy.

Essay [Each question is worth 5 points.]

Answer the following questions with at least one paragraph.

35. There are several compelling reasons Christians give for believing that the Bible is God's Word. List three of them.

Answers will vary but should include three of the following:

- **Despite being written by 40 authors over 1,500 years, the Bible tells a cohesive story.**
- **The Bible has been shown to be historically reliable on many accounts.**
- **Hundreds of Bible prophecies have been fulfilled.**
- **Unlike many ancient books, the Bible includes surprising and embarrassing details about the sins and failures of God's people.**
- **The Bible is still read today and continues to transform people's lives.**

36. What evidence supports the idea that Scripture has been reliably preserved over time?

Answers will vary but should include that we have many manuscripts of Old and New Testament writings. Discoveries like the scroll of Isaiah from the Dead Sea Scrolls confirm the manuscripts have been accurately preserved. Scribes were very careful in copying Scripture. And though there are 400,000 textual variants among the 234,000 New Testament manuscripts, only about one percent of these impact the meaning. Most differences are slight changes in word order or spelling. None of the textual variants affect key doctrines.

37. Explain how the canon of Scripture came to be. Include the Old Testament, the Apocrypha, the New Testament, and the three tests in your explanation.

The canon is the collection of biblical writings accepted as genuine and authoritative by Christians. The Bible has two parts: the Old Testament and the New Testament. Before Jesus was born, Jewish people saw that God inspired the writing of specific books and these became the Old Testament. The Apocrypha is Jewish literature written after the intertestamental period, but it is not part of the biblical canon. The early church used three tests in recognizing books as Scripture: apostolicity (was the book written by an apostle?), orthodoxy (did it conform to the teaching of the apostles?), and pedigree (was it accepted by most churches?). The New Testament was finalized in the fourth century.